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**MUFG Bank, Ltd. and
MUFG Securities plc**

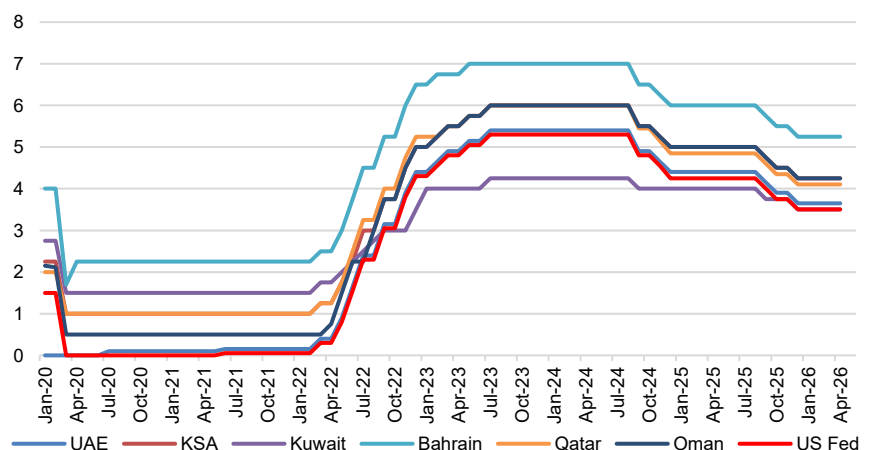
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COMMODITIES / ENERGY

Oil hits wartime high as escalation risks intensify. Oil prices surged to wartime highs, with Brent climbing above US\$122/b and WTI nearing US\$109/b, as fears of renewed US military action against Iran and a prolonged disruption in the Strait of Hormuz drove market anxiety. President Trump is reviewing new military options while maintaining a strict naval blockade on Iranian ports, signalling a hardline stance amid stalled negotiations. The near-total shutdown of Hormuz, one of the world's most critical energy chokepoints, has sharply reduced global oil and gas flows, fuelling what is the largest supply shock in modern energy markets. Iran has warned of retaliation if pressure continues, raising the risk of broader regional escalation, while the US is also intensifying economic measures, including tanker seizures and expanded sanctions. With supply tightening and geopolitical tensions rising, oil markets remain highly volatile and vulnerable to further upside shocks.

Gold rebounds slightly as Fed divisions and inflation risks weigh. Gold prices edged higher, rising about 0.7% to above US\$4,580/oz, as dip-buying emerged after a three-day decline, even as a divided Fed kept interest rates unchanged. The central bank's 8–4 split, the widest dissent in decades, highlighted growing uncertainty over policy, with some officials signalling concern about persistent inflation that could require higher rates, a negative for non-yielding gold. Rising Treasury yields further pressured gold, while the ongoing Middle East conflict, now in its ninth week, continues to fuel inflation risks through elevated energy prices and the near-total shutdown of the Strait of Hormuz. Despite the modest rebound, gold remains under pressure, down around 13% since the war began, although continued central bank buying has helped cushion the decline.

GCC INTERBANK INTEREST RATES (%)



Source: Bloomberg, MUFG Research

MIDDLE EAST – CREDIT TRADING

End of day comment – 29 April 2026. Another mixed day ahead of the Fed. Oil prices continue to go up and that in turn pressures UST. But with some price stickiness the higher yields still translate into tighter spreads overall as flows remain balanced. Like yesterday front end and belly are 2/3bp tighter on the flattening UST curve. Long end bond prices though reacted again more to the underlying yield move and closed unch/+1bp in spread terms. QATAR 50s was active and last down at 85.50 (-0.25pt/unch). In the ADGB curve 70s underperformed a touch closing -0.375pt/+2bp. OMAN had a strong day in the belly of the curve with buying interest in 28s-31s where cash even closed a touch higher in price and about -5/-6bp. Fins saw new EBIUH 6.25 perp trading very strong closing 100.625/100.875 from 100 reoffer. Early morning it traded up at 100.375, but most trades where around 100.75. A break of 5% in 30y bonds will probably be met by some outflows/selling first.

MIDDLE EAST – MACRO / MARKETS

Gulf central banks maintain policy rate in line with Fed decision. Gulf central banks kept their key interest rates unchanged after the US Fed opted to hold policy rates steady, underscoring their commitment to monetary stability under dollar-pegged exchange rate frameworks. Qatar Central Bank kept its Deposit Rate at 3.85%, Lending Rate at 4.35%, and Repo Rate at 4.10%. The Central Bank of Bahrain held its overnight deposit interest rate at 4.25%, citing the need to maintain monetary and financial stability in light of global financial market developments. Similarly, the Central Bank of the UAE maintained its base rate on the overnight deposit facility at 3.65%, with short-term borrowing rates kept at 50bps above the base rate, a move explicitly noted as following the US Fed's decision on reserve balances. The synchronized approach reflects the longstanding monetary policy alignment between Gulf states and the US, driven largely by their currencies' pegs to the US dollar.

World Bank sees Middle East war to drive sharpest commodity price surge since 2022. The outbreak of war in the Middle East in early 2026 has caused unprecedented disruptions to global commodity markets, most critically through the near-total closure of the Strait of Hormuz, a chokepoint carrying roughly 35% of global seaborne crude oil trade. They project that the Middle East conflict will drive average commodity prices up 16% in 2026, the first annual increase since 2022, representing a 25% upward revision from January projections. Global energy prices are forecast to surge 24% this year, with Brent crude oil projected to average USD86/b, a steep rise from USD69/b in 2025, before reverting to USD70/b in 2027. Natural gas prices are expected to climb sharply on both sides of the Atlantic, with European prices projected to rise 25% and Japanese LNG prices forecast to surge nearly 33% this year. Fertilizer prices, particularly urea, are projected to soar 31% in 2026 due to export disruptions and surging natural gas input costs, pushing fertilizer affordability to its worst levels since 2022. The World Bank warns that risks are firmly tilted upward, if disruptions prove more protracted, Brent could average USD95/b to USD115/b, potentially pushing an additional 45 million people into acute food insecurity.

CALENDAR – DATA / EVENTS / MEETINGS

	Country	Date and time	Indicator/Event	Period	Consensus	Previous	Market Moving*
	TU	4/30/2026 11:00	Trade Balance	Mar	--	-9.03b	!!!
	SR	4/30/2026	SAMA Net Foreign Assets SAR	Mar	--	1698.3b	!!!

Source: Bloomberg, MUFG Research; * Bloomberg Relevance Score between "!", "!!" and "!!!"

MARKET INDICATORS

Stock markets	Index	Chg, %	
		Daily	YTD
Regional			
MSCI GCC	764	0.34	3.96
Bahrain	1,967	0.48	-4.80
Kuwait	9,364	0.51	7.77
Oman	8,268	0.49	40.93
Qatar	10,612	-0.10	-1.40
Saudi Arabia	11,238	0.52	7.12
Dubai	5,861	0.06	-3.07
Abu Dhabi	9,901	0.67	-0.92
Egypt	52,383	0.29	25.23
Israel	4,372	1.19	20.40
Turkey	14,311	-0.13	27.08
Jordan	204	0.04	11.44

International			
MSCI World	4,607	-0.16	3.98
MSCI EM	1,618	0.10	15.24
CSI 300	4,810	-0.01	3.88
DAX	23,955	-0.27	-2.19
DJIA	48,862	-0.57	1.66
EURO STOXX 50	5,816	-0.34	0.43
FTSE 100 Index	10,213	-1.16	2.84
Nikkei 225	59,214	-1.17	17.63
S&P 500	7,136	-0.04	4.24

3m interbank rates	%	Chg, bp	
		Daily	YTD
Bahrain	5.12	0.01	2.80
Kuwait	3.56	0.00	0.00
UAE	3.76	1.75	8.20
Qatar	4.08	2.00	2.64
Saudi Arabia	4.73	-0.37	-2.63
Turkey	16.01	0.00	0.00
SOFR	3.66	-0.15	0.32

Exchange rates	Rate	Chg, %	
		Daily	YTD
USD/BHD 1yr fwd	162.60	-5.29	-12.88
USD/KWD 1yr fwd	-222.54	3.31	-14.12
USD/OMR 1yr fwd	8.00	6.67	-46.67
USD/QAR 1yr fwd	14.93	12.34	-62.71
USD/SAR 1yr fwd	174.00	-0.57	-50.62
USD/AED 1yr fwd	-7.28	3.83	80.61
USD/EGP 1yr fwd	19.96	0.05	-13.58
USD/TRY 1yr fwd	43.12	-1.45	-16.69
USD/ILS 1yr fwd	-204.55	-0.76	-45.69

Sovereign bonds	Yields, %	G-S*, bp	Chg, bp		Coup, %
		Daily	Daily	YTD	
Short-term bonds (1-2 years)					
Bahrain 2028	6.518	257.88	0.23	0.25	7.000
Kuwait 2027	4.296	56.12	0.03	0.00	3.500
Oman 2027	4.545	70.95	-0.02	-0.59	6.750
Qatar 2026	4.249	60.62	0.10	0.06	3.250
KSA 2027	3.086	34.93	0.08	0.49	0.750
UAE 2027	4.140	31.26	0.00	0.07	3.125
Egypt 2027	5.926	210.40	0.00	-2.38	5.800
Turkey 2027	5.068	124.88	0.05	-1.15	8.600
Israel 2027	3.259	64.39	0.08	0.29	1.500
Jordan 2027	5.190	146.20	0.01	-1.03	5.750

Medium-term bonds (3-5 years)					
Bahrain 2030	6.601	258.90	0.07	0.14	7.375
Oman 2030	4.661	64.42	0.00	-0.32	4.875
Qatar 2030	4.331	31.37	0.05	0.17	9.750
KSA 2030	4.561	56.65	0.04	-0.06	4.750
UAE 2030	4.384	37.64	0.00	0.32	3.125
Egypt 2030	8.177	413.68	0.07	-1.06	7.625
Turkey 2030	6.222	220.08	0.07	-0.91	9.125
Israel 2030	4.763	74.33	0.06	-0.41	2.750
Jordan 2030	5.951	193.01	0.08	-1.65	5.850

Long-term bonds (6+ years)					
Bahrain 2035	7.027	265.66	0.11	-0.05	7.750
Qatar 2035	4.500	13.77	0.07	-0.02	4.875
KSA 2035	4.944	65.31	0.04	-0.02	5.000
UAE 2034	4.620	31.14	0.00	-0.03	5.000
Turkey 2035	7.049	269.68	0.08	-0.04	6.500
Israel 2037	4.229	106.48	0.00	-0.02	2.375

International bonds (10 years)					
US Treasury	4.423	---	-0.01	0.26	4.125
German Bund	3.109	---	0.04	0.67	2.900
UK Gilt	5.071	---	0.07	0.63	4.750
Japan Government Bond	2.511	---	0.05	1.20	2.400

Commodities	USD	Chg, %	
		Daily	YTD
Brent	71.31	4.46	104.65
WTI	66.10	2.30	91.79
Gold	4,991	0.18	5.48
Copper	12,881	-0.25	4.68
Aluminium	3,078	-1.41	16.46
EU natural gas	4,991	0.18	5.48
US natural gas	32.50	2.00	78.80
Iron ore	98.50	0.03	0.01
Coal	247.00	0.00	9.46
Commodities (BCOM)	626.12	1.57	26.00
Energy (BCOMEN)	332.36	4.41	59.43
Base metals (BCOMIN)	167.44	0.18	8.03
Precious metals (BCOMPR)	1,572.90	-1.26	5.27
Agriculture (BCOMAG)	4,991	0.18	5.48

Source: Bloomberg, MUFG Research; * G-spread = interpolated bond spread to sovereign curve of matching currency

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